KALPANA TALAN, PMP®, CSM®

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SUMMARY

As a Program Management professional with 10 years of experience, I have led complex, mission-critical programs across IT, operations and risk management, delivering transformation and operational excellence in high-risk environments. In the last 3 years, I have led digital transformation and enterprise-wide deployments, reducing manual documentation by 80%, achieving 95% operational readiness and 100% mission success. My strengths lie in strategic execution, risk mitigation, stakeholder management and leading diverse teams through high-pressure change.

SKILLS

Program Management: Program & Project Management, Strategic Planning & Execution, Agile & Scrum, Cross-Functional Leadership, Resource Management, Project Lifecycle Management

Operational Excellence: Risk Management, Process Improvement, Change Management, Procurement & Contract Management, Crisis Management, Data Analytics & Reporting, Operational Readiness

Tools: Jira • Notion • Trello • Click Up • Miro • Asana • Gantt Chart • AirTable • Zapier • n8n • Google Suite • Lovable • Supabase • Figma • Bolt • AntiGravity

EXPERIENCE

INDIAN AIR FORCE

- **Program Manager** **Jan 2022 – Jan 2026**
  - Spearheaded regional rollout of a paperless maintenance platform with timestamped sign-off for 100+ air defence assets in 4 months with Wipro, cutting audits from 5 days to 1.
  - Led from-scratch air defence system relocations across regions with a 65-member team and 20+ vendors, achieving zero critical downtime, 95% availability and audit clearance.
  - Achieved 100% success with zero safety incidents in a real-time, national-security live missile firing, leading a 45-member team through planning and multi-agency coordination.
  - Extended air defence system total life by 10% and achieved 95% readiness via predictive maintenance.
  - Optimised 10,000+ spares for ₹500 crore of assets via forecasting and procurement with a 100+ team.

- **Senior Project Manager IT & AFNET** **Aug 2021 – Jan 2025**
  - Accelerated processing of operational, maintenance and admin files from 3 to 1.5 hours for 250 users by deploying E-Office, a paperless filing system, with a cross-functional team of 20.
  - Drove adoption of a central e-governance platform, mapping 8+ manual processes, setting data standards and liaising with HQ, cutting military transport vehicle turnaround by 75%.
  - Slashed leave-approval time by 58%, from 6 hours to 2.5 hours, for 200 users by designing and implementing an automated Excel-based leave-tracking system with a team of 3.

- **Program Manager, Non-Profit Welfare Initiatives** **Jan 2020 – Nov 2024**
  - Grew partnerships 8 to 10+, attendance 100+ via error-free 500+ member finances, authority liaison.
  - Established platforms for 20+ women entrepreneurs at 10+ shops and livelihood ventures via stalls, exhibitions and direct sales, managing governance, strategy and operations.
  - Saved 1 hour of daily collation for 100+ monthly requests via a paperless workflow with 90%+ accuracy.

- **Senior Project Manager** **Jan 2018 – Jan 2022**
  - Merged 2 units with a 90-member team and no data loss, moving ₹50 crore in assets and 10,000 records.
  - Cut fault rate and risk by 27% and downtime by 25%, meeting a 75% utilisation target.

- **Human Resources Manager** **Jan 2019 – Nov 2023**
  - Boosted productivity by 25% for 300 staff via 100% on-time appraisals and 10-to-7-day disciplinary cases.
  - Raised efficiency by 13% and fleet-wide safety and learning via mentoring and best-practice workshops.

- I have also worked in the Indian Air Force as a Military Trainee from 2016 to 2018.

PROJECTS

- **5 days → 1:** Paperless Maintenance Platform that moved 100+ assets off paper | Explore
- **PMO Autopilot (Notion + Zapier):** a project register that briefs you every Monday | Explore
- **Pet Care Companion:** 48 hours, 4 people, 3 countries, 1 live MVP | Explore

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EDUCATION

M.Tech Aeronautical Engineering - Visvesvaraya Technological University 2016 – 2017
B.Tech Electrical & Electronics Engineering - Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Technical University 2010 – 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

Project Management Professional (PMP) - PMI 2025
Certified Scrum Master (CSM) - Scrum Alliance 2025
Generative AI Overview for Project Managers - PMI 2025
Management Essentials Program - IIM Shillong 2026